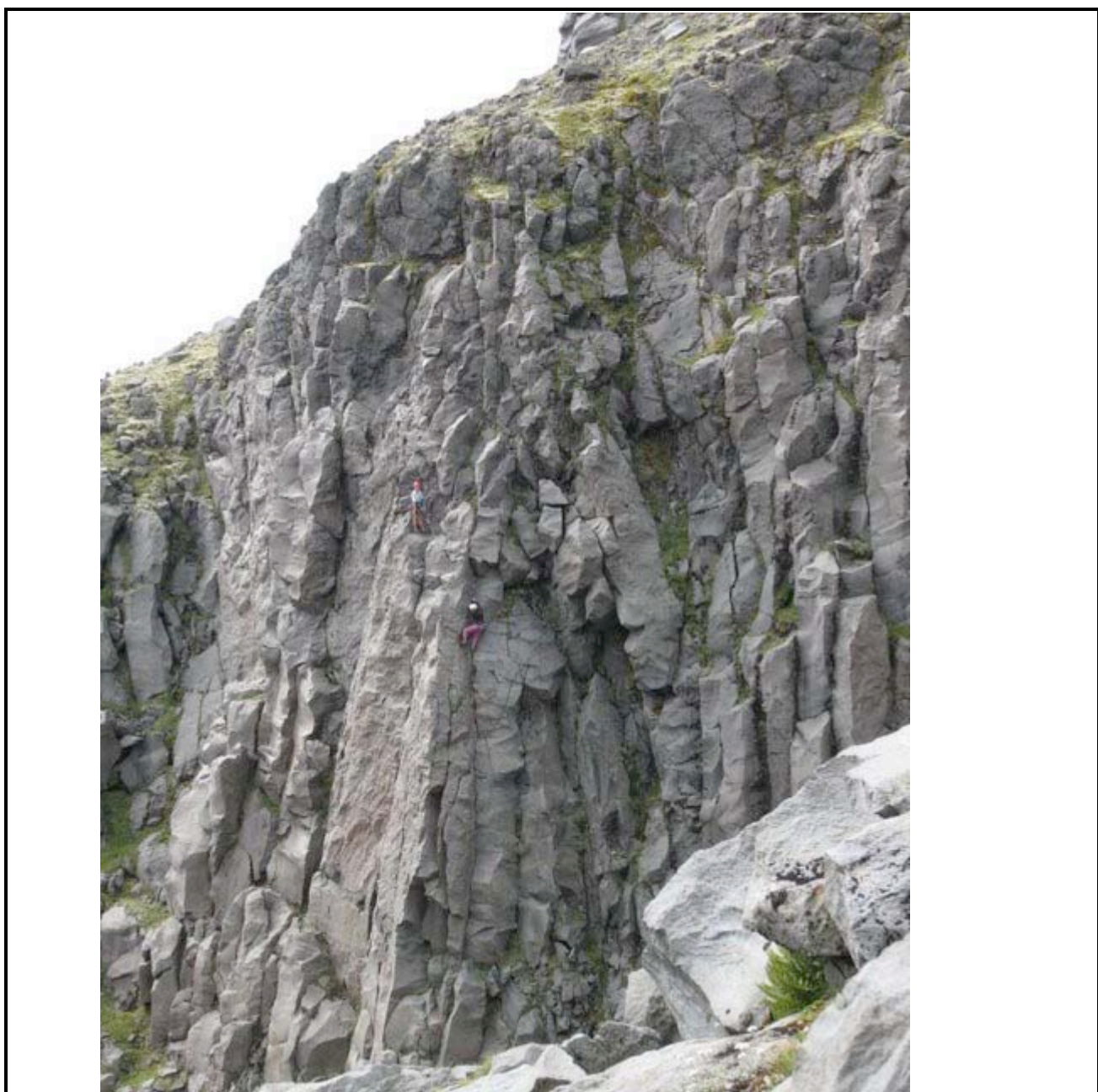




VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 708 March 2008 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N



Planet Hemp, Taranaki (Merewyn Groom)

nzac national bouldering series 2008



Crank, Crimp and Slap your way to the top of the 2008 National Bouldering Series at this year's Baring Head Rock Hop

Registration from 9.00am

Competitors briefing at 9.45am

Competition starts at 10.00am sharp!



The NBS is coiled and ready to dyno into the year. All the features of previous years; cool prizes, Chalky Digits limited edition T-shirts (available at the events), the NBS website and of course more problems than a Survivor episode.

Categories will be Expert, Junior and Recreational with male and female divisions in each.

Further information at www.nbs.org.nz or contact Chris North at (03) 3777595 or email at chris@alpineclub.org.nz.

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Section Night 3 March 2008

Short Talks. Come along and hear what your fellow Club members have been up to over such a fabulous summer



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



From Mike O'Brien (sounds like NZ this summer)

Hi Rach. I'm dying. The weather is dreadful... sticky, hot and humid. I've been stuck inside for days. It's too hot and humid to go out, and I miss climbing. I can't even swim at the beach, because of the deadly jellyfish. Time to reminisce...

Margaret River

Margaret River is another of those iconic Australian destinations. The Margaret River region in Western Australia is regarded by many Aussies as a small corner of paradise; the gourmet foods, wine and beautiful beaches draw hordes of people seeking to unwind and live it up. For climbers, the allure of the region lies with the small seaside crag of Willyabrup. Despite the less

than inspiring name, Willyabrup offers some great short routes, and with the fantastic rest day options nearby, it's yet another crag worth visiting.

Location: All the way over in Western Australia – but worth the trip if you combine it with a visit to West Cape Howe. A few hours south of Perth. Willyabrup crag is a 5 minute stroll from the car park, and sits beside the Indian Ocean.

Climbing: Short routes up to 30m, predominantly trad with the odd carrot and staple bolt. Well featured rock, with horizontal and vertical cracks, slabs, and little rooflets. Parts of the crag are popular with commercial groups, so quite a few bolted anchors along the tops.

Grades: Good range, but knock a couple of grades off if there has been an off shore wind, as the rock will be a little greasy.

Season: The area is at its best in summer, but is good all year round. Avoid the school holidays if possible.

Accommodation: Great DOC style camping spots, with good facilities. Heaps of other accommodation options, from basic to ultra luxurious.

Services: Stock up on climbing gear in Perth, otherwise you'll be able to get all you could possibly want and more in Margaret River and surrounding wineries etc.

Guidebook: *Margaret River Rock*, by Shane Richardson, Stone Publications, is pretty good. It also details the other little crags in the area.

Rest Day Activities: You will truly be spoilt for choice! Spending a couple of days ambling from winery to winery is highly recommended. Alternatively, the surf is great, as are the many caves.

And Remember: Satiating your every desire is the main pursuit in Margaret River – don't be surprised if you never quite make it to the crag....



Hamilton (the mountain...)

In the second week of January Steve Dowall and Tom Wilson walked up the Tasman to a high camp in the Bonney Glacier. From there they completed a possible new rock route on West Face of Mt Hamilton (3025m). The climb dog-legged up the face through 9 pitches of generally good rock, 2 of choss. Crux grade about 15. The pair topped out late, and in the growing darkness were unable to pass the final pinnacles on the ridge to the summit, so an unplanned bivy ensued. Resuming the following morning, the summit was reached and they descended to camp via the North West Ridge.

Conditions on the lower Tasman moraine seem to have deteriorated, with the previously large flat areas on the true left now seeming quite jumbled up. On the walk out we crossed to the true

right after leaving the white ice, towards Cinerama Col and down close to the Ball Glacier - this seemed to offer better travel.



Figure 1 - Steve Dowall on Pitch 5 West Face of Hamilton, Bonney Glacier below



Arthurs Pass – Franklin and Phills

Two NZAC Wellington members (Kevin Patterson and Laurie Griffin) planned a rock climbing trip to Malte Brun (3199m) over the New Year period. Unfortunately due to forecast poor weather up high for the planned summit day (Thursday) we diverted to Arthurs Pass and bagged Franklin and Phipps instead. Franklin was a 3 day trip with an interesting walk in up the Mingha and down the Deception Rivers to Deception Hut. This forms part of the Coast-to-Coast race held each year in February and so we saw many practise runners coming through! Summit day was stunning and we had perfect conditions. After a 6am start we climbed from 750m to summit the 2145m peak at 4pm in the afternoon. 2 very enjoyable pitches from the south col could have been avoided if a more direct line had been taken. But then we would have carried

the rope for nothing! We got back to the hut just on dark (10pm) and walked out down the Deception the following day passing a further 31 runners on the way in the drizzle.

After a rest day with a bit of late afternoon bouldering at Quantum Field, we climbed the 1960m Phipps Peak at the head of Temple Basin Skifield. One pitch on the way up and 8 raps to descend directly to the scree slopes below. 12 hour day all up, again in perfect conditions.

See <http://www.facebook.com/photo.php?pid=564467&l=11d2e&id=783826158> for photo's and more detail.



From Richard Davies...

Just after Xmas, (Boxing Day even), Quentin Duthie and I from the section along with Jo Hoare and Bruce Galloway from the Canty/Westland section headed up the Paringa. After an easy evenings walk into the late Tony Condons hut we trudged up to Tunnel Ck in increasingly heavy rain. Noting that the Paringa bivy rock already had two in it we had the afternoon off and watched the Paringa rise, fall and rise.

The next day we were up before the Sparrows were farting and climbed steadily through the wet bush. We carried on past the rock biv and took the high route that climbs snowgrass, then rock and crosses numerous snowfields and lines of easy slabs towards Mt McCullaugh. By this stage the clag had come in and we debated turning around but decided to keep following the footprints of the pair from the rock (being Erik Bradshaw and Christine Ryan), eventually their footprints turned round and after pondering how we had walked past each other in the clag we pushed on up. You cross a notch in the ridge then traverse a ledge and snowfield on the Paringa side of McCullaugh before crossing another notch and descending the McCallaugh glacier. We tiptoed across the snowbridge over the schrund, and felt our way down in the clag (as a side note we looked at the route from the Solution range a few days later and with a clear view of our footprints from across the valley we could see that we managed to pick about the only line that would go on the glacier which was pleasing). We camped on some pleasant benches above Murdock Creek.

The next day we headed over to Marks Flat and saw Blair and Nicky at the airport biv, we pushed on to try and cross the Landsborough. We got down to a good crossing I have used previously but after a bit of mucking around decided it wasn't for all of us. We had a day with some OUTC/OSONZAC folk who were doing some uni work from a camp on Toe Toe flat then took a spur directly up to Mt Solution sidling west near the top to save some climbing. A rough descent to the Clark followed before exiting via Zeilian Pass and the Moeraki. A neat trip.

After another weeks tramping in North West Nelson Quentin and I wanted light packs so headed up to Esquilant biv with the idea of scrambling up Earnslaw. Iced up rocks in the couloir (and a tight timeframe) put paid to that, so we headed back out and down to Fiordland. A nice overnighter nonetheless.

After a good thrash around Fiordland, Quentin and I joined Graham Bussell from the Wgtn Section, Eric Duggan from CNI and Emma Richardson from CUTC for a look at Arawhata country. We left Raspberry Flat late in the afternoon and made good quick time to Liverpool biv. Arawhata Saddle looked to have a disconcertingly small amount of snow on it, but we

wandered up the next day to 'have a look'. The Moirs route (climbing to the right (looking up) then cutting back left) was a hopeless proposition with an ugly waterfall and debris threatened slopes, so we climbed more or less directly up the centre on rock most of the way, only needing the rope for one short section with the rest being scrambles of varying difficulty. We got down to Arawhata rock for the night which is a neat spot, all the more neater after a vigorous scrub workout.

A couple of days took us down to Williamson flat and up the Joe to the Victor Creek bivy rock. A day of rain rescued us from ourselves and we enjoyed the rest. In the evening we went and found the rock bridge mentioned in Moirs and still very much in existence and very easy despite what some parties had told us. It's worth finding, other crossings are reasonably ugly. We had glorious weather that befitted the glorious line that is Destiny ridge, however this season Destiny ridge was more Destiny church and "enough was enough" with the slopes cut off at the rock outcrop at 2080m. Rather than passing it on the Passchendale glacier side as per Moirs we found a 30m abseil on to a snowbridge required to get around it. We got as far as setting up the abseil but then decided with no guarantee that the rest of the route was open (from what we could see the slopes under Solution col looked very broken) and no safe way back on to Destiny ridge (and thus down) if it didn't go we reluctantly turned around. Brian Tamaki might have gone for it.

The day got a bit crapper when we found the mountain radio was broken which meant we couldn't find out whether the party we had heard in the vicinity of Whitbourn saddle was able to get through. With not enough food to try and fail again, and O'Leary pass not enticing us we reversed - and the good news was that the Joe and Arawhata were a lot easier and faster in reverse. There's no question that if the river allows you should stay in it up the top of the 'whata. We got from Williamson flat to the very top of the Arawhata in a comfortable day with barely a scratch from Twin Falls Creek onwards. From there it was a nice walk out via the Waipara and Matukituki saddles and the length of the West Matukituki.



Last but not least – Taranaki rock (Paul Grimwood)

Eleven Wellington rock warriors (say that quickly) travelled in 3 cars to climb the rock of Taranaki. However, for now, let us ignore the large sample and interesting analyses such as mean passengers per vehicle and deal with a single representative transit module (a Toyota Carib for the anally retentive). The trend these days is to draw massive conclusions from meaningless data: 'House price growth in the 3 months to January drops from 10.1 to 8.9%' shock horror. Should the trend continue and reach zero percent growth we predict a levelling in house prices! Right, back to the trip: 46 litres of 91 were consumed in order to ferry 4 persons plus gear from Wellington to North Taranaki, a total trip distance of about 640 km (7.2 l/100km for the anal retentive). Of those 4 people, 1 of them scaled 7 climbs, 2 topped 6 and 1 bagged 5, which when presented graphically would render as a beautifully symmetrical bell-shaped normal or poisson distribution, with a convenient mean and mode of 6 climbs per person, or about 1.9 litres of fuel per climb to take things in an environmental direction. To put these data in perspective: On a recent trip to Turakirae – a considerably shorter distance from Wellington - 3 climbers in a Subaru Impreza, which is kind of irrelevant since there are no petrol consumption logs for the journey, failed to climb any boulders successfully, and since when you divide

something by nothing things tend to skyrocket, our trip to Taranaki was better for the planet by several orders of magnitude. It's not what you would think really is it. Less travel time equals less petrol and more climbing time should equal more climbs. A lower fuel to climb ratio and healthier for the environment, one would think. Whether these startling data are consistent with some sort of 'the further you travel the more climbs you do' hypothesis or a dramatic increase in talent admittedly remains in the balance. Either way it seems likely that should the trend continue, when we go to the Arapiles in March, we will be climbing a lot.

Climbing trips to Taranaki tend to take all weekend. After all, it does involve 640 km of driving plus there is a big walk up a steep hill in the middle of the night. Dinner is more or less inevitable at some point, usually in the evening after some climbing. On Saturday night – at dinner in fact – a further important and statistically significant discovery was made during an ad-hoc epidemiological study conducted despite the fact that most peoples brains had shifted into some sort of energy efficient sleep mode. Yes, more rich conclusions from semantically sparse data. One food group cooked up a hotter and spicier concoction than expected. The air at Tahurangi Lodge was saturated with chilli fumes for a short while and there was much coughing until windows were opened. On masticating, the two male members of that particular gastronomic unit started to perspire in the eyelid area. This is OK as it turns out. Clearly, it's a physiological fact that men have more sweat-like ducts in the eyelid region than women and these ducts or glands react to a number of stimuli funnily enough none of which is ambient temperature. So guys, next time you start to choke as The Pogues come on the jukebox singing 'Dirty Old Town' and you're feeling all emotional after necking 5 pints of beer on an empty stomach, maybe you're reminded of your brother and when the world seemed an easier and better place, rest assured, your manhood is intact, you're not really crying, it's just eyelid perspiration.

Anyway back to the trip and more data, more statistics, but serious this time because this is after all meant to be a climbing report and climbing can be dangerous and beta should not be tainted. We climbed hard on the Saturday as rain was forecast for Sunday. To minimise wasted time most of us stuck to one area: a 20 m stretch of the Organ Pipes around the Left Nostril with a clutch of routes in the 14 to 16 range. I found the rock to be sound, many of the routes worthwhile and protection generally good. The guidebook was accurate in its grading and rating and the starred routes were all fun. All of the routes here require placement of natural pro with many routes focussed on crack lines although often the face has a number of ledges and holds. Routes were around 20 m and generally required building a natural anchor. The guidebook talks of walking off but we tended to rap off a rope slung around a rock. As well as climbing on the Organ Pipes, James and Simon climbed Planet Hemp (18) on Little Eiger wall and said it was a good climb and then top-roped the 21 to its left and then Pills and Thrills (17) or something like that, both of which were also worthwhile although they reckoned the 21 was over-graded. I don't have a guidebook, hence the vagueness. You need a guidebook to climb at Taranaki by the way. So we only touched the tip of the iceberg that is Taranaki rock. I'd be keen to go back. A wise person might consider leaving around lunch time on Friday and taking Monday off work and checking the weather forecast to ensure Saturday and Sunday are going to be good in order to improve on 1.9 litres of fuel per climb. On Sunday it did rain so we headed home, end of story. Thanks to Alison, Blair, Nicky, Amanda, Dave, Lezar, James, Simon, Merewyn and Josh for a good weekend and an extra big thanks to James for leading the trip.



FROM NATIONAL OFFICE – BOOKS FOR SALE

Past President, Dave Bamford, has offered the NZAC a percentage of the money raised from the sale of surplus

books from his personal collection. A list of the books available can be viewed under the Publications Heading;

Library Books – Surplus Sales on our website (page 350). In addition, more books have recently been added to

the NZAC surplus book sales list on the same page. Money raised is kept aside for the ongoing care of the

NZAC Reference Library and Archives Collections.

If you have any enquiries, or wish to make a purchase, please contact

Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz



ALPINE GUIDES REUNION

REUNION OF ALL PAST ALPINE GUIDES FOX GLACIER STAFF

There is to be a reunion of all staff who have worked at Alpine Guides Fox Glacier on the weekend of 19/20 April 2008

It will be a great weekend with good food and drink, lots of stories and a band called the Hobnail Boots. Go to the website www.agwreunion.co.nz for details and to register. We need people to register urgently as we need final numbers.

Mike and Carol Browne



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FOR SALE

For sale: Beal 60 m half rope, hardly used, \$150, size 9 Koflach plastics good condition \$25, email newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

FREE to a good home:

BIVI BAG: Seam sealed, orange Malair on the top, grey pvc coated nylon on the base. Home-made but used only once (I'm not much of a climber!) Made large to potentially fit 2 in case of emergency. Phone 021 1105688 or email jennyklosser@yahoo.co.uk. Free delivery!



CONSERVATION BOARD NOMINATIONS 2008

The Minister of Conservation has recently advised that he is seeking nominations of suitable people for appointment to NZ's 14 regional conservation boards. Appointments are for a 3 year term commencing 1 September 2008. Fifty four members have terms expiring on 31 August 2008.

As well as suitable personal or professional qualifications and conservation experience, appointees will need to have the time and energy to commit to the role. The next 3 years will see many conservation boards reviewing conservation management strategies or national park management plans. This work involves a lot of reading and consideration of views of the public.

It is important to note that members do not represent those who nominate them. Boards are intended to be representative of the community as a whole and their duty as a board member is to discharge the functions of the board.

Would Clubs please circulate this information around their members and encourage them to give consideration to suitable candidates for the boards. More information on the boards and the process can be obtained from Department of Conservation Conservancy Offices or:

Katrina Edwards Phone: 04 471 3289 email: kedwards@doc.govt.nz
www.doc.govt.nz Go to 'Getting involved', 'NZ Conservation Authority and Boards'

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AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz). Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

21-30Mar08 – Copland Valley – Leader = Don French

Easter Trip – lead by “The Master”. There are plenty of mountaineering objectives off the Copland valley. Easter is early this year. Hope to have a fairly large group heading up the easy access from the westcoast. Numerous objectives prevail, including Mt Sefton (3151m) via Scotts creek and the Douglas Neve. There are a number of alternative objectives (e.g. Lyttle Peak – 2240m) for those not so keen on Sefton’s lofty heights. There is only one rule: “No summit, no Hot Pools”! Tramping options include the Copland Pass and the Baker Saddle circuit. Contact Don at 027 445 2980 or 06 377 7117 or by email at df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

24-28Apr08 – Mt Murchison (2408m) - ANZAC weekend trip – Leader = Don French

Highest peak in Arthurs Pass NP. Route in will be up the Waimakariri River via Carrington Hut, then the White River to arrive at Barkers Hut at the base of the White Glacier. Ideal for those who have recently completed the AIC. Contact Don at 027 445 2980 or 06 377 7117 or by email at df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

9-11May08 – Whanganui Bay, Taupo – Leader = TBA

An old favourite. Come along for a weekend of trad climbing on some quality rock, against the backdrop of the largest lake in the North Island. Hone up on those rock skills with some full pitch climbs. Enjoy the hot pools nearby when your day is done. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

30May-2Jun08 – Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku (2880m) – Leader = TBA

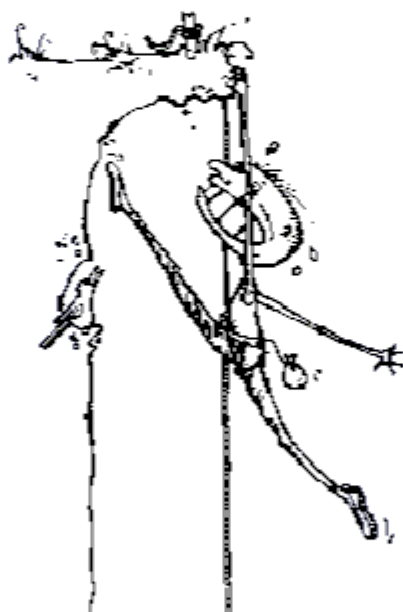
Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary’s early climbs back in the 1940’s, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we’ll take 3! On Friday night we’ll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we’ll attempt a summit via the traditional south ridge. No ropes required. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Wellington Section Directory: 2008 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	N/A
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> RS	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Phil Doole		N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

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